

compass

a launch film from a future where AI assists, and never creates

why

the story of AI and the fear of 'replacing' creatives

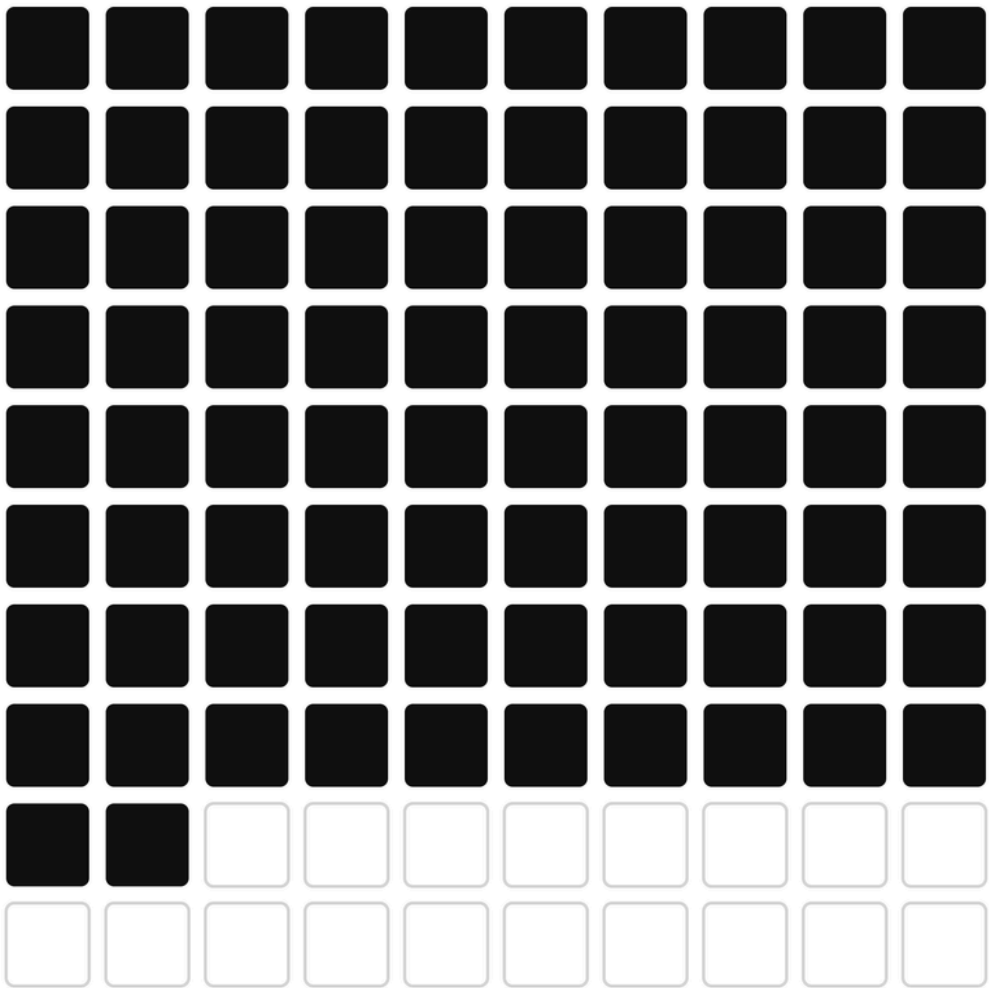
- The loudest story about AI and creativity is replacement: the tools get better, the maker becomes optional
- That story is already deciding how creatives in Aotearoa feel about their work, before the future arrives

why

the story of AI and the fear of ‘replacing’ creatives

82%

of AU/NZ music creators fear AI could end their ability to make a living



APRAAMCOS, 2024 · each square = 1 in 100

why

the story of AI and the fear of 'replacing' creatives

entertainment workers and AI

expectation of net job loss in their field

59%

expect AI to eliminate
more jobs than it creates

41%

do not, or are
unsure

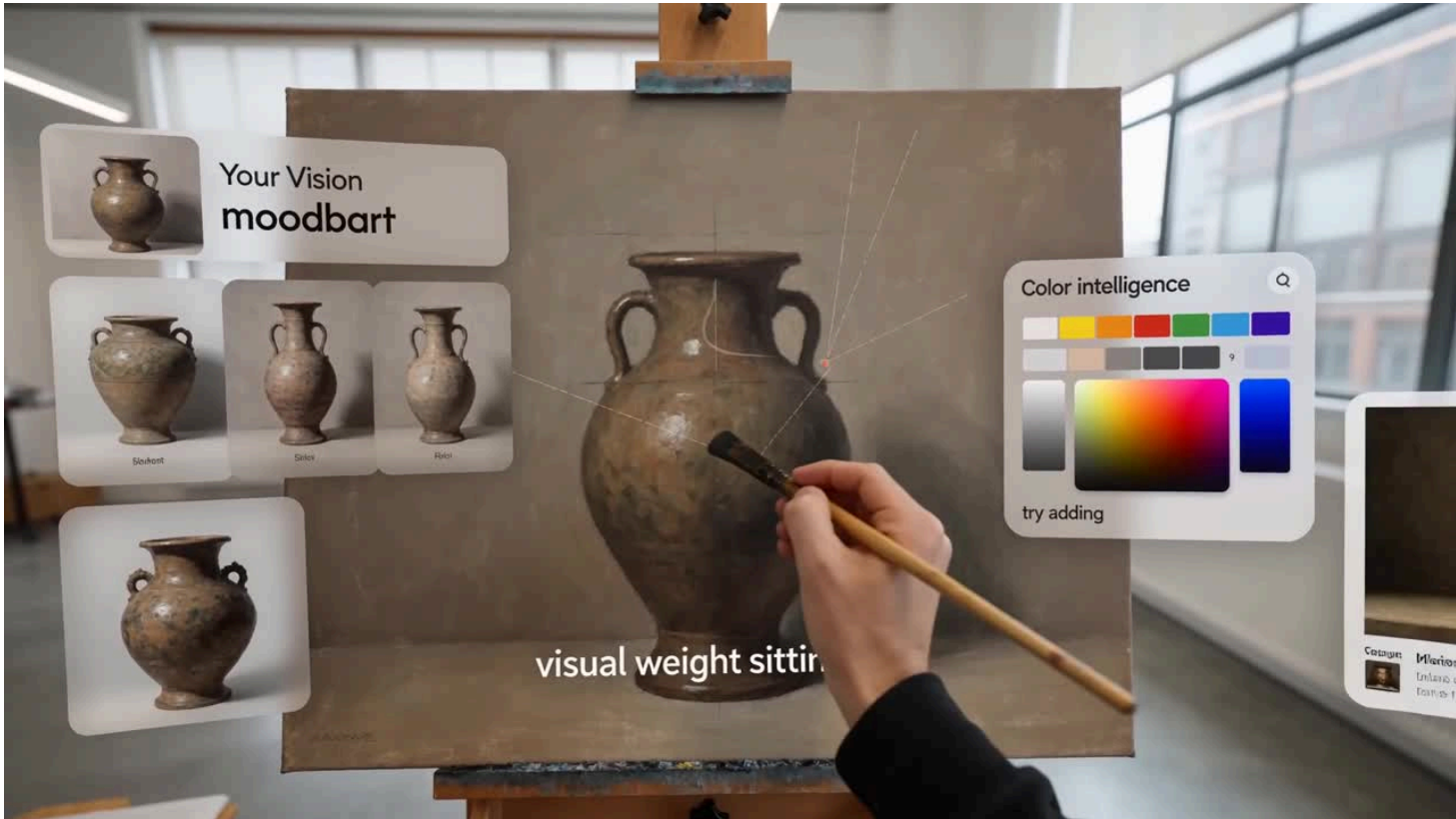
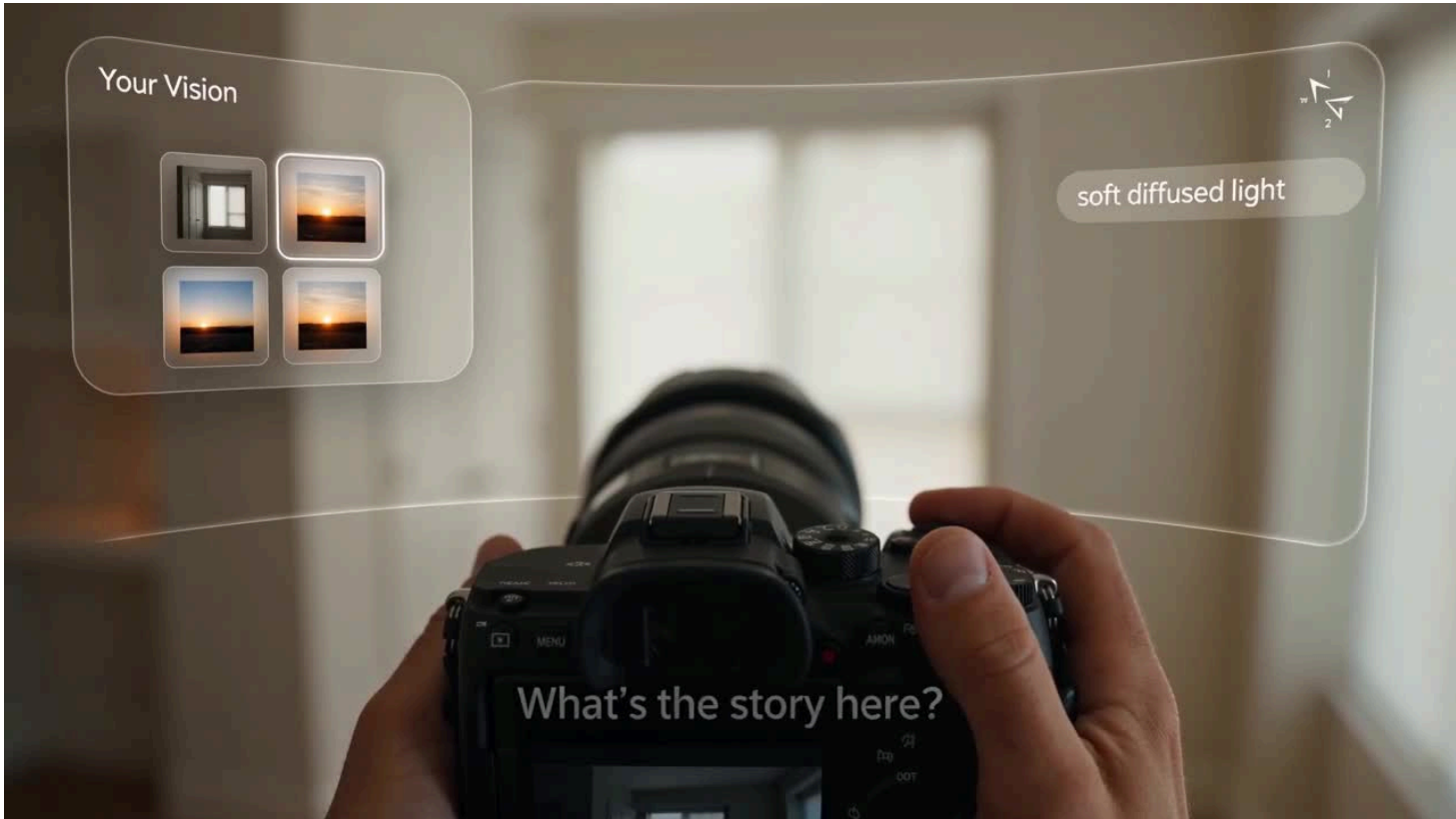
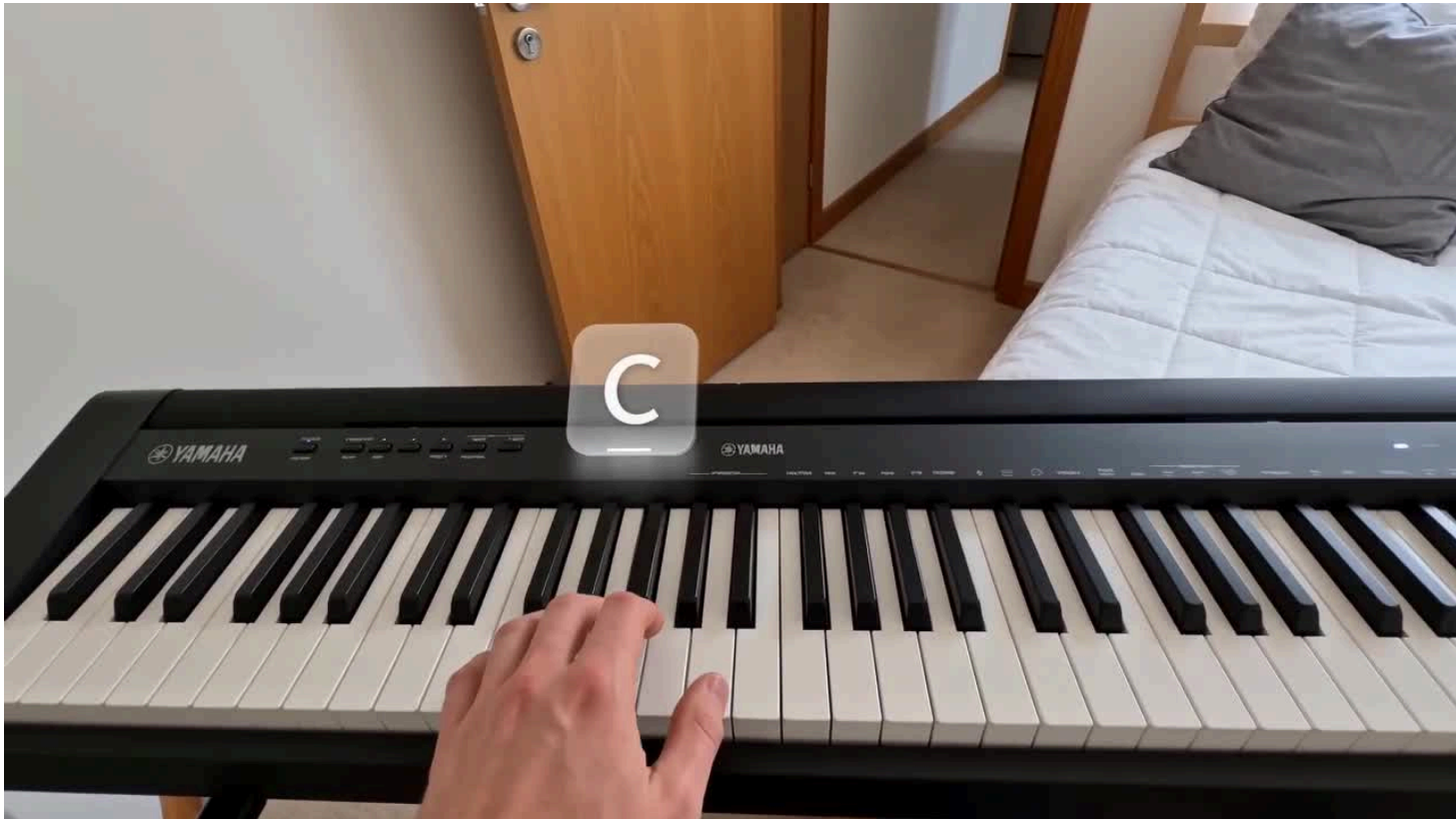
USC LABarometer, 2026

how might we use speculative design to help everyday creatives in Aotearoa feel what it means to work alongside AI, rather than be replaced by it?

what

*emerging technologies · AI-enabled AR glasses
for creatives · speculative launch film*

- A speculative launch film for fictional AR glasses built for creatives, set in near-future Aotearoa
- Looks and feels like an Apple launch film, for a product that doesn't exist - real enough to want, open enough to question
- The AR is only the display. The AI is the collaborator: it reads what you're making and suggests the next move
- One rule: it does not create, it only assists.



who

stakeholders · audience · motivation

- Primary: everyday creatives in Aotearoa: filmmakers, designers, musicians, the people currently framed as AI's victims
- Around them: the local creative industry, design educators, and the technologists deciding how these tools land here
- They engage because the film sells a desirable future, then leaves them holding the question of whether they want it

how

*product design · world-building · shoot ·
composite · film*

- This is not a promotional video. It is a diegetic prototype (Kirby, 2010) produced to full commercial standard, bringing my film practice to the depth a capstone demands
- Build the product as a looks-like appearance model, correct to camera, non-functional
- Work in staggering fidelity: storyboard, then a no-VFX test cut, then the final composited film, testing each stage with people
- Early-start risk: the spatial UI compositing. Learning After Effects is scoped from week one because it has the longest lead time

designing the product

a believable device, built before a frame is shot

01

talk to creators

what they fear and
want from AI

02

define it

purpose, rules, the
world it lives in

03

design the form

the object and its
on-lens UI language

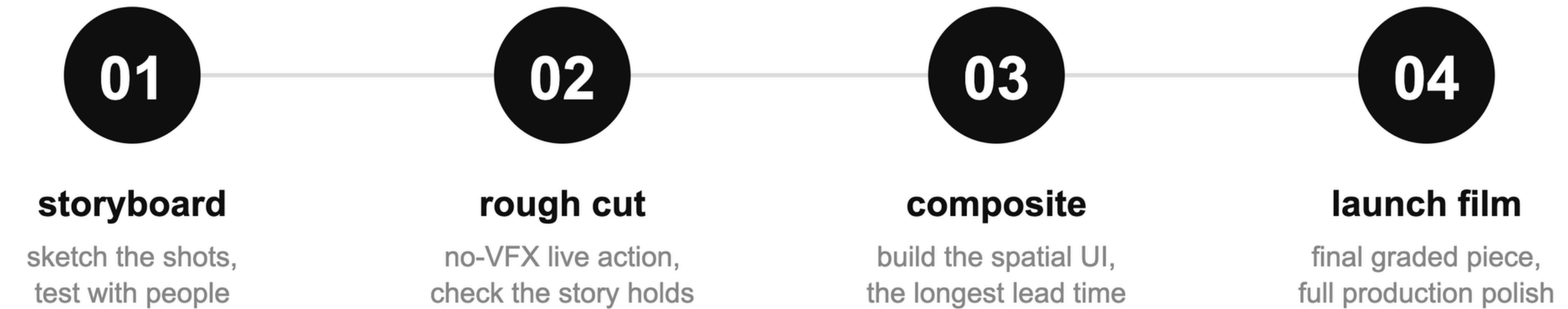
04

appearance model

a looks-like build,
non-functional, on camera

how it gets made

staggered fidelity, tested at every stage



**not by replacing the maker, but by changing what it feels
like to make.**